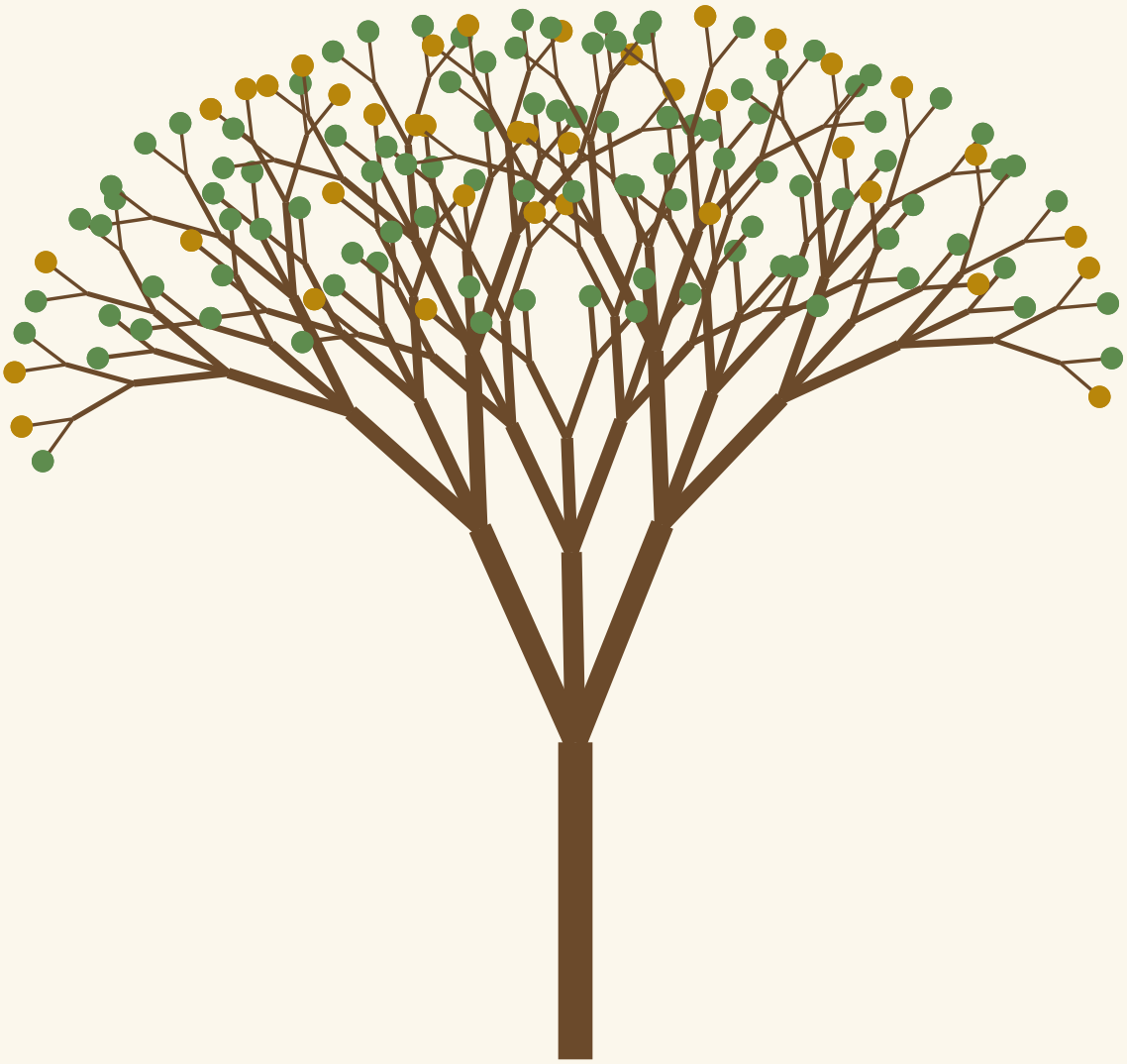
THE BIBLE FAMILY TREE

From Adam to Jesus Christ

Genealogies, family diagrams, key verses (KJV) and source references



Compiled October 2026 - Genesis, Ruth, 1 Chronicles, Matthew and Luke

Overview: The Line of Promise

The Bible traces one family thread from the first man to the Messiah. Genesis follows it from Adam to Noah (chapter 5), then from Noah's son Shem to Abraham (chapter 11). Ruth 4 and 1 Chronicles 2 carry it from Judah to David. Matthew 1 and Luke 3 then follow it from David to Jesus. This guide walks through each stage with a diagram, the key verses, and the sources used.

Genesis 3:15 introduces a promised descendant of the woman, and the genealogies show that promise passing from one generation to the next. Wiersbe's commentary describes Genesis 11:10–26 as a "bridge" between God's choice of Shem and the call of Abraham, which fits the way the whole chain works.

> *And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.*
> **Genesis 3:15 (KJV)**

The Master Line (Adam to Jesus)

1. Adam	**21.** Isaac	**41.** Jotham
2. Seth	**22.** Jacob	**42.** Ahaz
3. Enosh	**23.** Judah	**43.** Hezekiah
4. Kenan	**24.** Perez	**44.** Manasseh
5. Mahalalel	**25.** Hezron	**45.** Amon
6. Jared	**26.** Ram	**46.** Josiah
7. Enoch	**27.** Amminadab	**47.** Jeconiah
8. Methuselah	**28.** Nahshon	**48.** Shealtiel
9. Lamech	**29.** Salmon	**49.** Zerubbabel
10. Noah	**30.** Boaz	**50.** Abiud
11. Shem	**31.** Obed	**51.** Eliakim
12. Arphaxad	**32.** Jesse	**52.** Azor
13. Shelah	**33. David**	**53.** Zadok
14. Eber	**34.** Solomon	**54.** Achim
15. Peleg	**35.** Rehoboam	**55.** Eliud
16. Reu	**36.** Abijah	**56.** Eleazar
17. Serug	**37.** Asa	**57.** Matthan
18. Nahor	**38.** Jehoshaphat	**58.** Jacob (father of Joseph)
19. Terah	**39.** Joram	**59.** Joseph
20. Abraham	**40.** Uzziah	**60. Jesus**

Adam to David follows Genesis 5, Genesis 11, Ruth 4 and 1 Chronicles 2. David to Jesus follows Matthew 1 (the royal line through Solomon). Luke 3 gives a different route after David, covered in Part 6. The numbers are positions in this list, not an exact generation count, because biblical genealogies can skip generations.

What Is in This Guide

Part	Title	Main passages	Covers
1	**Adam to Noah**	Genesis 4–5; Luke 3:36–38	Seth’s line and Cain’s line
2	**Noah to Abraham**	Genesis 10–11; 1 Chronicles 1	Table of Nations and ten generations
3	**Abraham’s Family**	Genesis 11–25, 35	Isaac, Ishmael, Keturah, Lot, Esau, Jacob
4	**Jacob and the 12 Tribes**	Genesis 29–35, 49	Four mothers, twelve sons
5	**Judah to David**	Genesis 38; Ruth 4; 1 Chr 2	Perez, Boaz, Ruth, Jesse
6	**David to Jesus**	Matthew 1; Luke 3; 2 Samuel 7	Two genealogies compared

Reading notes

Ages and dates follow the Hebrew (Masoretic) numbers as printed in the King James Version. Other ancient texts differ in some of them. Spellings vary between Old and New Testament forms of the same name (for example Judah and Juda, Noah and Noe, Boaz and Booz, Shelah and Sala). “Begat” in Hebrew can mean “became the ancestor of”, so a list can legitimately skip a generation. Matthew 1:8, for example, moves from Joram to Uzziah, while 1 Chronicles 3:11–12 names three kings in between (Ahaziah, Joash and Amaziah).

Part 1: Adam to Noah

Genesis 5 • Genesis 4 • Luke 3:36–38

Genesis 5 opens with the generations of Adam and lists ten men down to Noah. Each entry gives the age when the line-son was born, the years that followed, and the total. The writer keeps coming back to the same ending (“and he died”), a reminder of Genesis 3. Two names stand out: Enoch, who “walked with God”, and Noah, who ends the list. Hebrews 11 names both among the heroes of faith. Luke traces Jesus back through this same line to Adam (Luke 3:36–38).

> *And Adam knew his wife again; and she bare a son, and called his name Seth: For God, said she, hath appointed me another seed instead of Abel, whom Cain slew.*
> **Genesis 4:25 (KJV)**

> *And Adam lived an hundred and thirty years, and begat a son in his own likeness, after his image; and called his name Seth.*
> **Genesis 5:3 (KJV)**

> *And Enoch walked with God: and he was not; for God took him.*
> **Genesis 5:24 (KJV)**

> *And Noah was five hundred years old: and Noah begat Shem, Ham, and Japheth.*
> **Genesis 5:32 (KJV)**

The Ten Generations

#	Name	Age at line-son’s birth	Years after	Total years	Reference
1	**Adam**	130	800	930	Gen 5:3–5
2	**Seth**	105	807	912	Gen 5:6–8
3	**Enosh**	90	815	905	Gen 5:9–11
4	**Kenan**	70	840	910	Gen 5:12–14
5	**Mahalalel**	65	830	895	Gen 5:15–17
6	**Jared**	162	800	962	Gen 5:18–20
7	**Enoch**	65	300	365	Gen 5:21–24
8	**Methuselah**	187	782	969	Gen 5:25–27
9	**Lamech**	182	595	777	Gen 5:28–31
10	**Noah**	500	450	950	Gen 5:32; 9:29

Enoch’s total (365) is the shortest because God took him. Noah’s years after the line-son are counted from Shem, Ham and Japheth’s birth to his death at 950 (Genesis 9:29). Adam was still alive when Lamech, Noah’s father, was born.

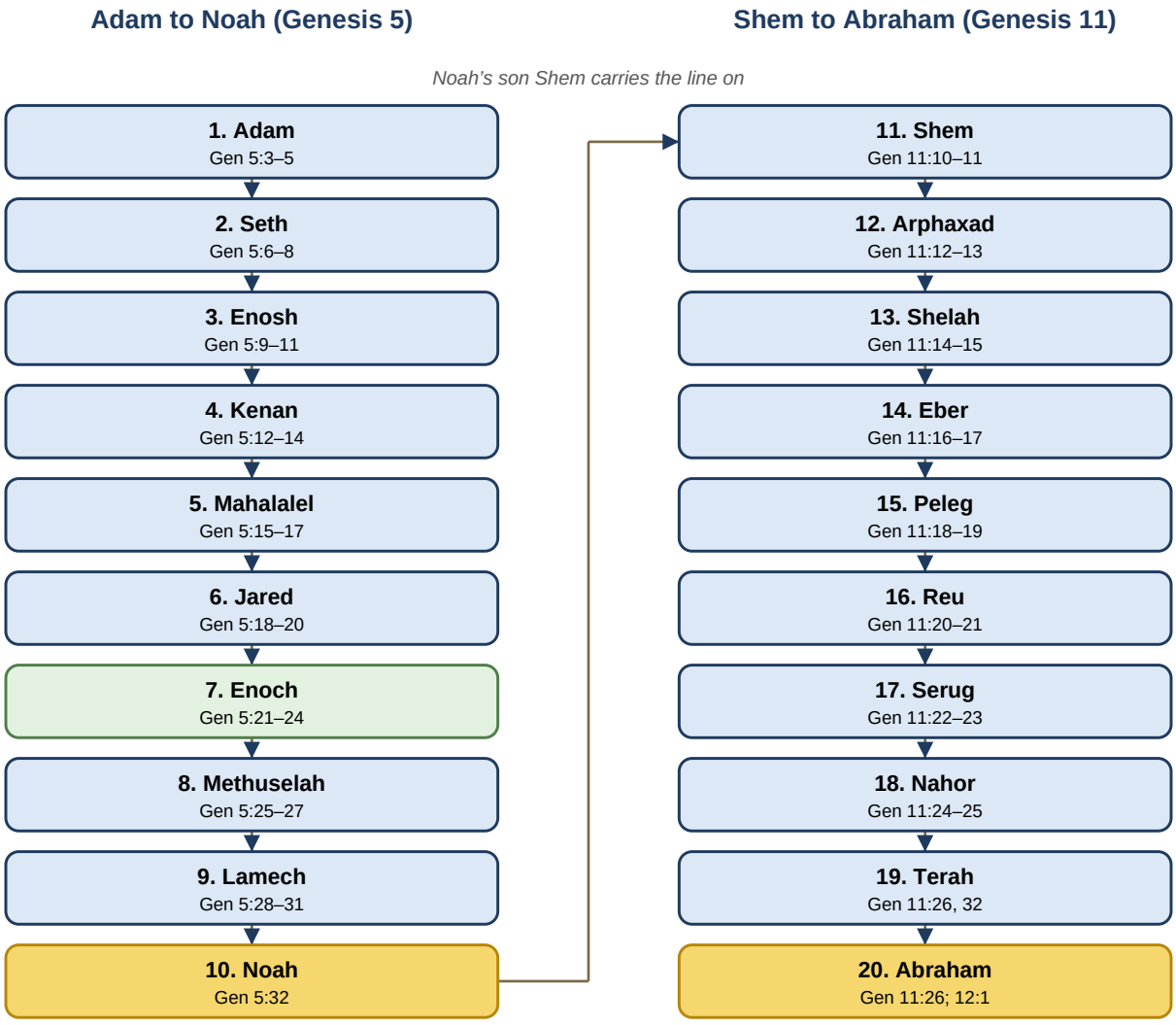
The Other Line: Cain’s Descendants

Genesis 4:17–22 gives a second family: Cain, Enoch, Irad, Mehujael, Methusael and Lamech. Lamech’s children Jabal, Jubal, Tubal-cain and a daughter, Naamah, are named for herding, music and metalwork.

Part 2: Noah to Abraham

Genesis 10–11 • 1 Chronicles 1 • Luke 3:34–36

After the flood, Genesis 10 lists the families that came from Noah's three sons. Genesis 11 then narrows to one branch, running from Shem to Terah, and ends with Terah's son Abram. Like chapter 5, it lists ten generations, but the lifespans are much shorter, falling from 600 years for Shem to 148 for Nahor. The ladder below puts both lists side by side.



The Ten Generations of Shem to Abraham

Name	Age at line-son's birth	Years after	Total years	Reference
Shem	**100**	500	600	Gen 11:10–11
Arphaxad	**35**	403	438	Gen 11:12–13
Shelah	**30**	403	433	Gen 11:14–15
Eber	**34**	430	464	Gen 11:16–17
Peleg	**30**	209	239	Gen 11:18–19
Reu	**32**	207	239	Gen 11:20–21
Serug	**30**	200	230	Gen 11:22–23
Nahor	**29**	119	148	Gen 11:24–25
Terah	**70 (at Abram, Nahor, Haran)**	—	205	Gen 11:26, 32

Luke 3:36 adds a "Cainan" between Arphaxad and Shelah. That name appears in the Greek (Septuagint) form of Genesis 11 but not in the Hebrew text, which is why Genesis and Luke differ here. Terah's remaining years are not given; he died at 205 (Genesis 11:32).

The Table of Nations (Genesis 10)

Son of Noah	Sons	Reference
Japheth	**Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, Tiras**	Gen 10:2
Ham	**Cush, Mizraim, Phut, Canaan**	Gen 10:6
Shem	**Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, Aram**	Gen 10:22

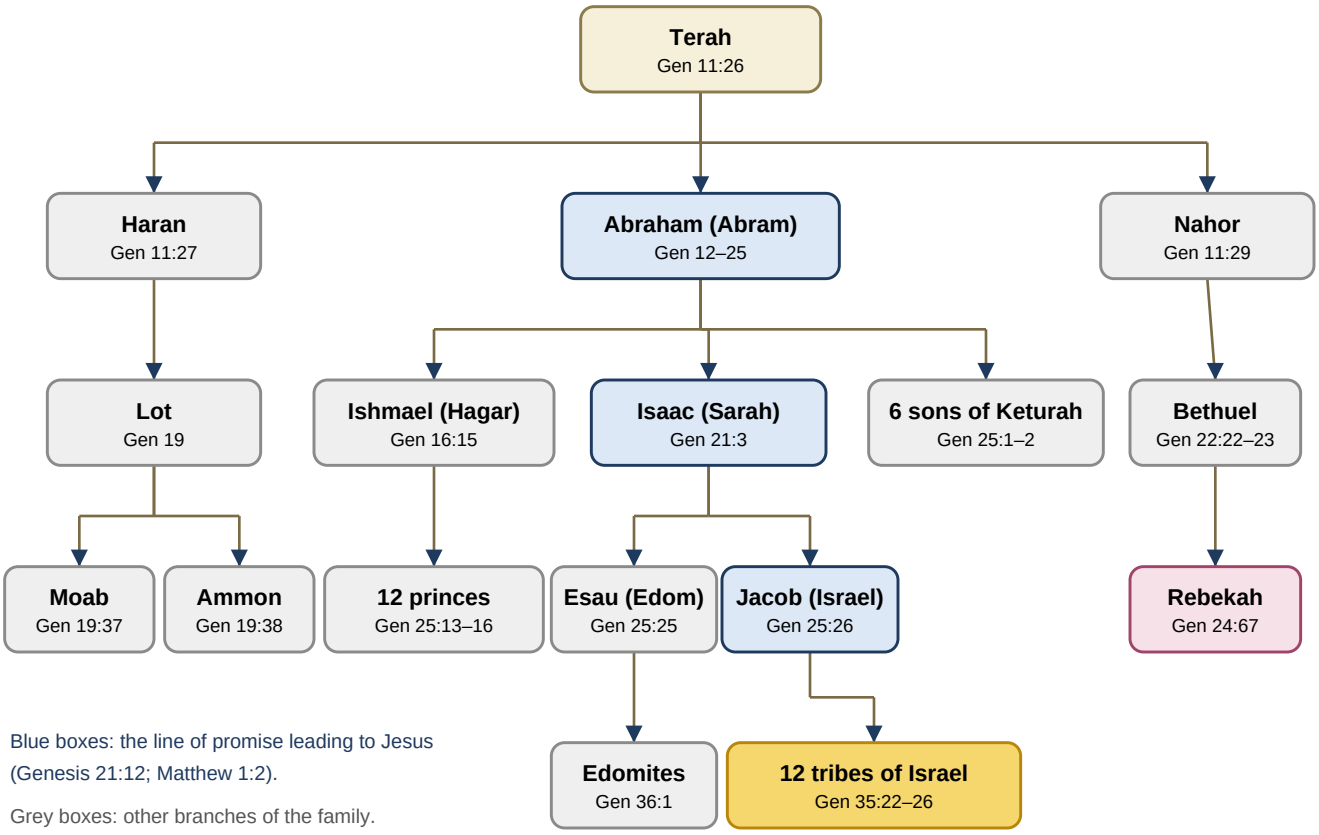
> *Now these are the generations of the sons of Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth: and unto them were sons born after the flood.*
> **Genesis 10:1 (KJV)**

> *And Terah lived seventy years, and begat Abram, Nahor, and Haran.*
> **Genesis 11:26 (KJV)**

Part 3: Abraham’s Family

Genesis 11–25 • Genesis 35 • Matthew 1:2

God called Abram out of Haran and promised him a great nation and a blessing for every family on earth. His family tree has several branches. Ishmael, born to Hagar, fathered twelve princes. Isaac, born to Sarah, is the son through whom the promise continued. After Sarah’s death Abraham married Keturah, who bore six sons. Abraham’s nephew Lot, the son of Haran, became the ancestor of Moab and Ammon. Isaac married Rebekah, the daughter of Bethuel, who was Nahor’s son, and their twin sons were Esau (Edom) and Jacob (Israel).



Blue boxes: the line of promise leading to Jesus (Genesis 21:12; Matthew 1:2).

Grey boxes: other branches of the family.

Pink: Rebekah, Isaac’s wife.

> *And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great; and thou shalt be a blessing: … and in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed.*
> **Genesis 12:2–3 (KJV)**

> *… for in Isaac shall thy seed be called.*
> **Genesis 21:12 (KJV)**

> *And after that came his brother out, and his hand took hold on Esau’s heel; and his name was called Jacob: and Isaac was threescore years old when she bare them.*
> **Genesis 25:26 (KJV)**

> *And he said, Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for as a prince hast thou power with God and with men, and hast prevailed.*
> **Genesis 32:28 (KJV)**

The Patriarchs' Ages

Patriarch	Key age	Age at death
Abraham	**100 at Isaac's birth (Gen 21:5)**	175 (Gen 25:7)
Isaac	**60 at Esau and Jacob's birth (Gen 25:26)**	180 (Gen 35:28)
Jacob	**130 when he met Pharaoh (Gen 47:9)**	147 (Gen 47:28)

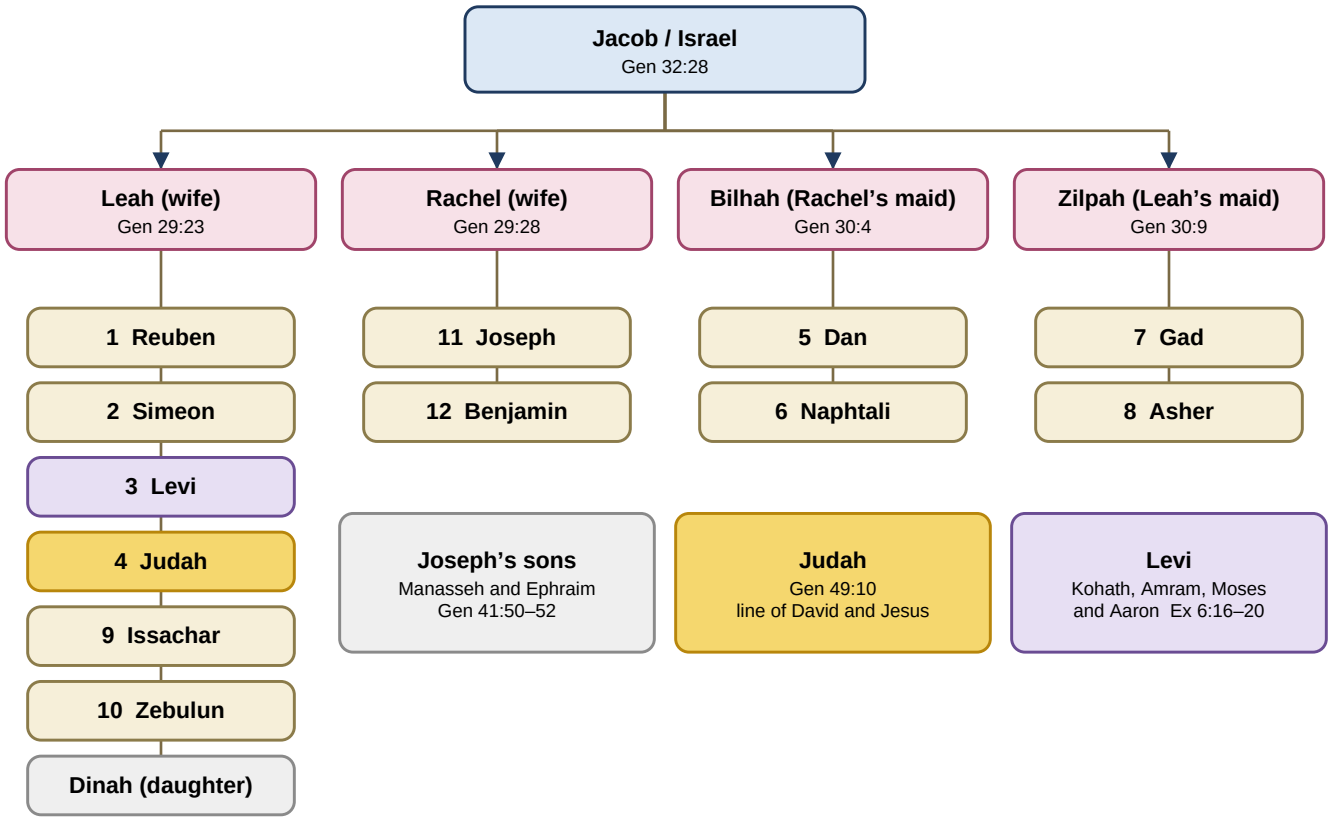
Ishmael's twelve sons (Genesis 25:13–16)

Nebajoth, Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, Mishma, Dumah, Massa, Hadar, Tema, Jetur, Naphish and Kedemah. Keturah's six sons (Genesis 25:2) were Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak and Shuah. Lot's two sons came from his daughters (Genesis 19:36–38): Moab, father of the Moabites, and Ben-ammi, father of the Ammonites.

Part 4: Jacob and the Twelve Tribes

Genesis 29–35 • Genesis 46 • Genesis 49

Jacob had thirteen children by four women: Leah, Rachel, and their maids Bilhah and Zilpah. Twelve were sons, and they became the twelve tribes of Israel after God renamed Jacob. Genesis 35:22–26 and Genesis 46:8–27 list them, and the lists appear many times across the Bible. Joseph's two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim, later became tribes, and Levi's tribe served as priests rather than receiving a land share.



Numbers show birth order (Genesis 29–30, 35:18). Gold: Judah. Purple: Levi, the priestly tribe. Pink: the four mothers.

> *Now the sons of Jacob were twelve: The sons of Leah; Reuben, Jacob's firstborn, and Simeon, and Levi, and Judah, and Issachar, and Zebulun: The sons of Rachel; Joseph, and Benjamin: And the sons of Bilhah, Rachel's handmaid; Dan, and Naphtali: And the sons of Zilpah, Leah's handmaid; Gad, and Asher.*
> **Genesis 35:22–26 (KJV)**

> *The sceptre shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between his feet, until Shiloh come; and unto him shall the gathering of the people be.*
> **Genesis 49:10 (KJV)**

The Twelve Sons: Birth Order, Mothers and References

Order	Son	Mother	Birth reference
1	**Reuben**	Leah	Gen 29:32
2	**Simeon**	Leah	Gen 29:33
3	**Levi**	Leah	Gen 29:34
4	**Judah**	Leah	Gen 29:35
5	**Dan**	Bilhah	Gen 30:6
6	**Naphtali**	Bilhah	Gen 30:8
7	**Gad**	Zilpah	Gen 30:11
8	**Asher**	Zilpah	Gen 30:13
9	**Issachar**	Leah	Gen 30:18
10	**Zebulun**	Leah	Gen 30:20
—	**Dinah**	Leah	Gen 30:21
11	**Joseph**	Rachel	Gen 30:24
12	**Benjamin**	Rachel	Gen 35:18

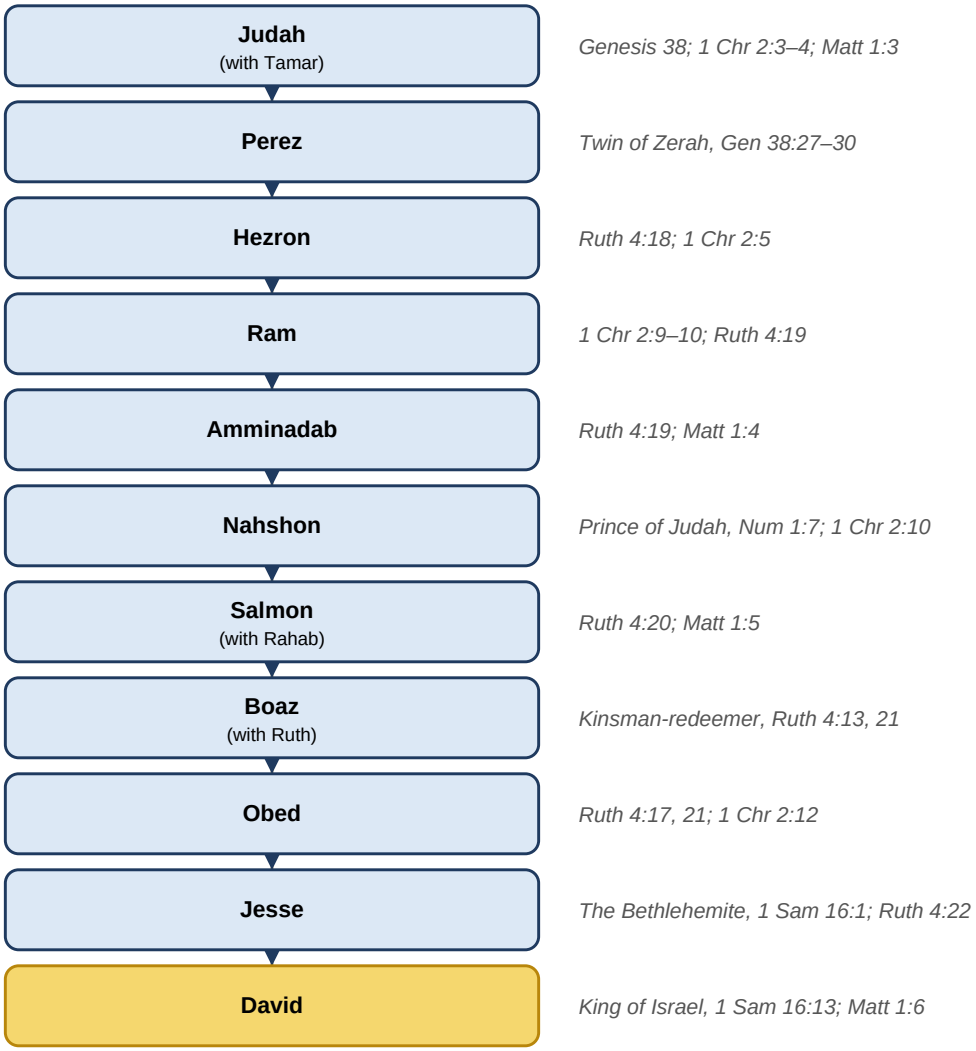
Why Judah?

Of the twelve brothers, Judah’s line leads to David and then to Jesus (Matthew 1:2–3). Jacob’s blessing in Genesis 49:10 points to Judah as the tribe that would hold the sceptre. Part 5 follows his descendants from Perez to David.

Part 5: Judah to David

Genesis 38 • Ruth 4:17–22 • 1 Chronicles 2:1–15 • Matthew 1:3–6

Ruth 4:18–22, 1 Chronicles 2 and Matthew 1 all agree on the chain from Judah to David: Perez, Hezron, Ram, Amminadab, Nahshon, Salmon, Boaz, Obed, Jesse and David. Judah had five sons in all. Two of them, Perez and Zerah, were born to his daughter-in-law Tamar. The Bible traces the royal line through Perez. The book of Ruth is the story of how Boaz redeemed Ruth, a Moabite widow, and how their son Obed became David's grandfather.



> *Now these are the generations of Pharez: Pharez begat Hezron, And Hezron begat Ram, and Ram begat Amminadab, And Amminadab begat Nahshon, and Nahshon begat Salmon, And Salmon begat Boaz, and Boaz begat Obed, And Obed begat Jesse, and Jesse begat David.*
> **Ruth 4:18–22 (KJV)**

> *And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab; and Booz begat Obed of Ruth; and Obed begat Jesse;*
> **Matthew 1:5 (KJV)**

Part 6: David to Jesus

Matthew 1:1–17 • Luke 3:23–38 • 2 Samuel 7

Matthew and Luke both bring the line to Jesus, but they take different routes after David. Matthew follows the kings through Solomon, and he groups the whole list into three sets of fourteen (Matthew 1:17). Luke goes through David's son Nathan and lists far more names. He also runs backward from Jesus to Adam and ends with God. The two lists meet again only at Shealtiel and Zerubbabel (Matthew 1:12; Luke 3:27), and they give Joseph a different father (Jacob in Matthew 1:16, Heli in Luke 3:23).

> *The book of the generation of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham.*
> **Matthew 1:1 (KJV)**

> *And Jesus himself began to be about thirty years of age, being (as was supposed) the son of Joseph, which was the son of Heli,*
> **Luke 3:23 (KJV)**

> *Which was the son of Enos, which was the son of Seth, which was the son of Adam, which was the son of God.*
> **Luke 3:38 (KJV)**

The Two Lists Side by Side (David to Jesus)

#	Matthew 1: royal line through Solomon	Luke 3: line through Nathan
1	**David**	**David**
2	Solomon	Nathan
3	Rehoboam	Mattatha
4	Abijah (Abia)	Menan
5	Asa	Melea
6	Jehoshaphat	Eliakim
7	Joram	Jonan
8	Uzziah (Ozias)	Joseph
9	Jotham	Juda
10	Ahaz	Simeon
11	Hezekiah	Levi
12	Manasseh	Matthat
13	Amon	Jorim
14	Josiah	Eliezer
15	Jeconiah	Jose
16	**Shealtiel**	Er
17	**Zerubbabel**	Elmodam
18	Abiud	Cosam
19	Eliakim	Addi
20	Azor	Melchi
21	Zadok	Neri
22	Achim	**Salathiel (Shealtiel)**
23	Eliud	**Zorobabel (Zerubbabel)**
24	Eleazar	Rhesa
25	Matthan	Joanna
26	Jacob	Juda
27	Joseph	Joseph
28	**Jesus**	Semei
29		Mattathias
30		Maath
31		Nagge
32		Esli
33		Naum
34		Amos
35		Mattathias
36		Joseph
37		Janna
38		Melchi
39		Levi
40		Matthat
41		Heli
42		Joseph
43		**Jesus**

Highlighted rows are names the two lists share (David, Shealtiel, Zerubbabel and Jesus). Rows are not generation-matched. Spellings follow the form each Gospel uses in the KJV.

Why Two Genealogies?

Christians have offered several explanations, and the sources I checked agree that none is certain. IVP's Luke commentary says plainly that there is no certain explanation. The main views are:

1. Joseph's line and Mary's line. Many conservative writers read Matthew as Joseph's legal, royal line and Luke as Mary's family line, so that "Heli" is Mary's father and Joseph's father-in-law. They point to Luke 3:23, "as was supposed", as a hint that Joseph is only named as Jesus' legal father (Apologetics Press; Spirit and Truth; Douglas Jacoby).
2. A levirate marriage. Another view, held by many early church writers, is that Jacob and Heli were half-brothers. When one died childless, the other married the widow under the law in Deuteronomy 25:5–6, so Joseph had a legal father and a biological father (Douglas Jacoby; Spirit and Truth).
3. Different purposes. Matthew writes for Jewish readers and stresses Abraham and David. Luke writes to a wider audience and goes back to Adam, to show that Jesus is the savior of all people. Andrew Wilson (Christianity Today) adds that Luke places his list at the start of Jesus' ministry, not at his birth.

Four women and Mary in Matthew's list

Matthew names women, which was unusual for a genealogy: Tamar (1:3), Rahab (1:5), Ruth (1:5), "her that had been the wife of Urias", meaning Bathsheba (1:6), and Mary (1:16). Rahab lived in Jericho (Joshua 2:1; 6:25) and Ruth is called a Moabitess (Ruth 4:10), so the royal line includes people from outside Israel.

The Promise Behind the List

> *And when thy days be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will set up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom. … And thine house and thy kingdom shall be established for ever before thee: thy throne shall be established for ever.*
> **2 Samuel 7:12, 16 (KJV)**

> *And there shall come forth a rod out of the stem of Jesse, and a Branch shall grow out of his roots:*
> **Isaiah 11:1 (KJV)**

> *And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ. So all the generations from Abraham to David are fourteen generations; and from David until the carrying away into Babylon are fourteen generations; and from the carrying away into Babylon unto Christ are fourteen generations.*
> **Matthew 1:16–17 (KJV)**

> *He shall be great, and shall be called the Son of the Highest: and the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of his father David:*
> **Luke 1:32 (KJV)**

Sources and References

Scripture quotations are from the King James Version, which is in the public domain. Web sources were used for background and to check names, passages and the explanations of the two genealogies; the wording in this guide is my own summary.

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Passages to read for yourself

Genesis 5; Genesis 10–11; Genesis 25; Genesis 35; Genesis 49; Ruth 4; 1 Chronicles 1–3; Matthew 1; Luke 3.